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SUMMARY

Fifteen years building and scaling distributed systems, across the industry's move from bare-metal servers and monoliths to cloud-native, Kubernetes and GitOps. I take on the work teams postpone: technical debt, CI/CD built from nothing, and keeping things up.

Engel & Völkers

2023

Luxury real estate — a regional office of the network

Fullstack developer, solo

Catalogue depth per session: 1.8 → 4.1 pages

- Property catalogue: listing grid, filters by location, property card
- Media galleries with lazy loading and WebP delivery
- Interactive map bound to the same filter state as the list

Sixt

2022

Car rental — a regional booking module

Front end, in a contractor's team

Result render and filtering: 2.8s → 0.6s

- Booking search: pick-up and drop-off location, dates, vehicle class
- Result list and vehicle selection screens
- Checkout forms and their responsive behaviour

99acres

2021

Property portal, India — catalogue search

Front-end developer, catalogue module

Filter response over the catalogue: 1750ms → 200ms

- Geo search: locality, radius and map-bounded queries
- Multi-criteria filters over the listing catalogue
- The property card those filters open

Locabens

2021

Tower crane and hoist rental, Brazil

Fullstack developer, solo

Enquiry conversion: 0.8% → 3.2%

- Rental catalogue built from scratch: equipment model, specifications, availability
- Filters by lifting capacity, lift height and jib radius
- Cost calculator for a shift and for a rental period

Tzu Chi Foundation Singapore

2022

Charitable foundation, Singapore

Fullstack developer, solo

Availability at campaign peaks: 91% → 99.9%

- Online donation module
- Events calendar with registration
- News section published in both languages

Beyond.pl

2022

Data centre and cloud infrastructure

Fullstack developer, solo

Catalogue and rack configuration load: 4.2s → 0.9s

- Corporate site for a data centre and cloud operator
- Capacity calculator: dedicated and VPS configurations, rack and unit count, bandwidth, Tier III/IV service levels
- Quote request flow carrying the configuration through to the sales team

33rd Company

2020

Property management, USA

Fullstack developer, solo

Request handling time: 300min → 15min

- Company site and tenant portal
- Maintenance request submission and tracking
- Rent paid online

Properstar

2023

Global property search — currency and locale

Front-end developer, localisation modules

Countries served by one interface: 50+

- Currency conversion across the catalogue
- Area unit conversion between metric and imperial
- Locale resolution and language switching

Merchant West

2021

Financial services, South Africa

Fullstack developer, solo

Valid applications per month: 120 → 380

- Site for a financial services company
- Leasing calculators
- Secured forms for submitting financial documents

Credit Africa Invest

2022

Lending

Fullstack developer, solo

Application processing: 2880min → 5min

- Online lending platform
- Scoring questionnaire feeding the decision
- Loan calculator

Figures are the clients' own. Roles are stated as scoped: several of these companies have their own engineering teams, and the entry names the module or region delivered rather than the whole product.

Senior DevOps / Platform Engineer

2022–2026

Cloud-native platform

Ran the Kubernetes platform product teams build on: a namespace arrives with quotas, ingress, TLS and monitoring already wired together, so shipping a service does not require learning the cluster. Delivery moved to GitOps — the repository holds the desired state, and anything changed by hand on the cluster is reverted automatically. The last physical servers went into hybrid cloud; maintenance spend fell 30–40%.

DevOps Engineer

2019–2022

Microservices migration

Dozens of microservices, each with a hand-built pipeline that had long since drifted from its neighbours. Reduced them to one template: a service declares its type and gets build, tests and deployment already assembled. Releasing stopped being a coordinated multi-day event — about fifteen minutes now, with no downtime.

Full Stack Engineer

2016–2019

SaaS product

One product end to end: backend, frontend and the infrastructure under both. Most of the work was the database under growing load — replication to spread reads, sharding to spread writes, and caching in tiers with explicit rules about which data is allowed to go stale. Most of the gain came from reading query plans rather than from buying hardware.

Full Stack Developer

2013–2016

Web platform

A monolith on classic virtualisation, released by hand against a checklist. Wrote the first deployment scripts and moved environment configuration out of people's heads and into the repository — the ancestor of what later got called CI/CD. This is where it became clear that a manual step in a release is not saved effort, it is a deferred incident.

Web Developer

2011–2013

Digital agency

LAMP on physical servers: PHP and MySQL, Apache and nginx tuned by hand, logs and crashes read the same way. An agency with no dedicated sysadmins — whoever wrote the site kept it running after handover. That is where the habit of looking at an application together with the machine it lives on comes from.

Go

Go, Gin, Echo, Chi, Fiber, GORM, sqlx, pgx, gRPC, Protocol Buffers, context, sync/atomic, Asynq (Redis), River (PostgreSQL), Viper, envconfig, testify, gomock, testcontainers-go, golangci-lint, air, buf

Python

Python, FastAPI, Flask, Django, asyncio, Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, Polars, DuckDB, httpx, aiohttp, BeautifulSoup, Scrapy, Playwright, Pydantic v2, msgspec, Celery, Dramatiq, ARQ, pytest, pytest-asyncio, hypothesis, coverage, uv, poetry, ruff, mypy

JavaScript and TypeScript

JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vue.js, Node.js, Express, NestJS, Astro, Redux, Zustand, Pinia, TanStack Query, SWR, Vite, esbuild, SWC, Webpack, Babel, CSS, Tailwind CSS, PostCSS, Sass/SCSS, CSS Modules, shadcn/ui, Radix UI, Headless UI, Framer Motion, Zod, React Hook Form, Valibot, OpenAPI/Swagger, tRPC, GraphQL, WebSocket, SSE, Storybook

PHP

PHP, Laravel, Symfony, 1C-Bitrix, WordPress, WooCommerce, Composer, PHPUnit, PHPStan, Psalm

Mobile and cross-platform

Flutter (Dart), React Native, Expo, Swift (iOS), Kotlin (Android), platform channels, CRDT (Yjs, Automerge), local-first, message signing, deterministic identifiers, offline-first sync

AI and LLM engineering

LM Studio, Ollama, llama.cpp, vLLM, OpenAI SDK, Anthropic SDK, Groq, litellm, GGUF, Q4_K_M, MoE, LangChain, LlamaIndex, Haystack, instructor, Pydantic AI, DSPy, sentence-transformers, FastEmbed, Qdrant, Milvus, Pinecone, pgvector, Chroma, Weaviate, MCP (Model Context Protocol), Ragas, prompt regressions, call tracing

SEO and semantic markup

Schema.org, JSON-LD, RealEstate, Product, Organization, Offer, Open Graph, Twitter Cards, XML-sitemap, robots.txt, canonical, hreflang, llms.txt, semantic hierarchy for parsing, Lighthouse, PageSpeed Insights, WebPageTest, web-vitals, next-intl, i18next, ICU MessageFormat

Storage, cache, search

PostgreSQL, Patroni, PgBouncer, MySQL, MariaDB, Redis, MongoDB, Memcached, Supabase, SQLite, ClickHouse, TimescaleDB, DuckDB, Qdrant, Milvus, Pinecone, pgvector, Neo4j, Meilisearch, Typesense, Elasticsearch, OpenSearch, golang-migrate, Alembic, Prisma Migrate

Queues, streaming, durable workflows

RabbitMQ, Kafka, NATS, NATS JetStream, Redis Streams, Asynq, ARQ, Celery, Dramatiq, Temporal, outbox, dead-letter queue, at-least-once + idempotency

Infrastructure, networks, DevOps, IaC

Linux, Git, Make, Docker, Docker Compose, k3s, Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, ArgoCD, Nginx, Caddy, HAProxy, Traefik, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, semantic-release, Conventional Commits, Terraform, Pulumi, Ansible, HashiCorp Vault, SOPS, age, Watchtower, GitHub Container Registry, n8n, AWS, GCP, Cloudflare (Workers, R2, Turnstile, Zero Trust), Vercel, Fastly, CDN

Observability and reliability

Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Loki, Tempo, Sentry, Uptime Kuma, healthcheck endpoints, SLO and alerting

Security and audit

Faraday CE, masscan, RustScan, nmap, naabu, httpx, nuclei, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, ffuf, gobuster, sqlmap, NetExec, Impacket, BloodHound, Responder, SharpDPAPI, DonPAPI, Wireshark, tcpdump, SMB, NFS, SFTP, WebDAV, Semgrep, Trivy, gitleaks, gosec, Bandit

Data, analytics, algorithmic trading

Pandas, Polars, NumPy, SciPy, TA-Lib, pandas-ta, ccxt, freqtrade, jesse, custom backtest engines, ClickHouse, TimescaleDB, DuckDB, Grafana, Plotly, TradingView Lightweight Charts, Prefect, Dagster, Airflow

Testing and load

Vitest, Jest, pytest, testify, PHPUnit, Playwright, Puppeteer, Cypress, Testcontainers, k6, Locust, Vegeta, schemathesis, Pact

Authentication, payments, access

JWT, OAuth2, OIDC, Keycloak, Authentik, Ory (Kratos, Hydra), Supabase Auth, Auth.js, Clerk, Stripe, payment provider webhooks, Cloudflare Turnstile, rate limiting